MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 1, Episode 1

"Enter. You Are Welcome Here."

Episode 1x01. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 1x01. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Thursday, June 30, 2005 (backstory) through Saturday, July 2, 2005, 12:41 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 44 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on canon documents MA-001 through MA-011

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on July 1, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Friday, July 1, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	25
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	25
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident	Aug 29, 1977	27
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Dr. Leland Graves (new)	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Nurse Yvette Banks	Lead Scrub Nurse	Dec 1, 1963	41
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	42
Hattie 'Miss Hattie' Lomax	Head Cook, Cafeteria	Mar 3, 1945	60
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Oliver 'Ollie' Freeman	Night Custodian	Nov 8, 1948	56
Destiny Lockhart (new)	Patient: ACOM aneurysm	Mar 3, 1988	17
Rochelle Lockhart (new)	Destiny's mother; Rikers C.O.	Nov 9, 1969	35
Earl Wynn (new)	Patient: Type A aortic dissection	Nov 2, 1946	58
Lamar Pittman (new)	Patient: retrocecal appendicitis	Jan 14, 1971	34
Ernestine Pope (new)	Patient: symptomatic gallstones	Aug 9, 1923	81

Also appearing: NY1 anchor (on TV), a transporter, nurses, an anesthesiologist, a neuro-angiography tech, and 12 non-regular interns from the 2005 class (18 interns in all).

Black don't crack (C-018): every regular reads several years younger than their age on screen. The ages above are exact and binding.

COLD OPEN

1 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OLD MAIN - THE ROOF - PRE-DAWN
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 5:24 AM

Darkness going blue. Across the East River, Midtown Manhattan sleeps in a haze of humid summer air. Below, the PEPSI-COLA sign glows red over the Hunters Point waterfront.

Seventeen SURGICAL INTERNS stand on the gravel roof of a 1927 Art Deco tower, in brand-new short white coats with the creases still in them. Nobody talks. Somebody's knee is bouncing.

Among them: AMOND BAKER (26), sharp-featured, a fresh line-up, staring at the skyline like he plans to buy it. ARIANNA CUMMINGS (25), box braids and a hurdler's frame, chewing gum like it owes her money. HARMONY DIVINE (26), round open face, already blinking back tears. RAVEN ELLISON (25), sunny, bouncing on her toes. And ESTHER SMILLEY (25), still and elegant, a woman who looks like she's holding her breath.

At the front, by the parapet: DR. NATASHA DONOHUE (47), Chief of Surgery. Regal, silver at her temples, a white coat like a crown. Beside her, a small woman with a short natural cut and a glare that could strip paint: DR. ELXA BULLOCK (27), surgical resident.

MARC (V.O.)
They tell you a lot of things in medical school. Anatomy. Pharmacology. Eleven different ways to say "I don't know" so the patient doesn't hear it.

MARC (V.O.)
Nobody tells you about the first morning. How quiet it is. How every single person on that roof thinks they're the only one who's terrified.

Natasha checks her watch. 5:25. One empty space in the line.

NATASHA
We're missing one.

ELXA
(flat)
Of course we are.

MARC (V.O.)
And nobody tells you that the first morning starts the night before.

FREEZE. THEN:

SUPER: "FIFTY MINUTES EARLIER."

2 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - MARC'S BEDROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 4:34 AM

A big bedroom in a big old brownstone: high ceilings, crown molding, moving boxes still taped shut. A digital clock reads 4:34 in red.

In the bed, tangled in sheets: DR. MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (26). Six-foot-five, all limbs, dimples even while sleeping. He looks about twenty-two.

A woman's bare foot steps on his hand on the floor next to the bed. He jolts awake.

MARC
Ow. Okay. Good morning to my hand.

Esther, half dressed, crouched on the floor, searching under the bed with the flashlight on her Motorola RAZR.

ESTHER
I'm so sorry. I can't find my other shoe.

MARC
(sitting up)
It's here somewhere. This room ate it. This room eats things. I lost a toaster in here Tuesday.

ESTHER
You keep a toaster in your bedroom?

MARC
I keep a toaster where the toaster wants to be. I'm not a dictator.

She almost laughs. Catches herself. Finds the shoe. Sits on the edge of the bed to put it on.

ESTHER
This was... I don't do this.

MARC
Me neither. I mean it. Ask anybody. Actually don't ask anybody, I just moved here, I don't know anybody.

ESTHER
(looking around)
You just moved here. Into this.

ESTHER
How many bedrooms is this?

MARC
Seven. Maybe eight. There's a door on the fourth floor I'm scared of.

ESTHER
How does a person who's twenty-what...

MARC
Six.

ESTHER
...twenty-six, get a seven-bedroom brownstone in Queens?

MARC
(easy, practiced)
Graduation gift. From my parents.

ESTHER
What did they graduate from? Owning Queens?

MARC
(grinning)
They really like me. I'm very likable. You saw.

That lands. She stands. Grabs her bag.

ESTHER
I have to go. I start something big today, and I can't walk in smelling like a bar.

MARC
Me too. Something big. Not the bar part. The bar part's just me.

A beat. Neither asks what the something big is. That's the deal they made at 1 AM.

ESTHER
It was nice to meet you, Marc.

MARC
It was nice to meet you, Esther.

She goes. Marc falls back on the pillow and smiles at the ceiling. Then he looks at the clock. 4:41.

MARC
(to the ceiling)
Do not be late. Do not be late on day one.

3 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 4:55 AM

A chef's kitchen with almost nothing in it: one box of Frosted Flakes and a jug of orange juice. Marc, in scrub pants and a Howard Bison T-shirt, eats cereal standing up. A small TV on the counter plays NY1.

ON THE TV SCREEN: NY1 MORNING HEADLINES, 5:00 AM. The crawl reads: SUPREME COURT JUSTICE SANDRA DAY O'CONNOR EXPECTED TO ADDRESS HER FUTURE TODAY ... HEAT ADVISORY FOR FIVE BOROUGHS THIS WEEKEND ... NYC 2012 OLYMPIC BID ENTERS FINAL WEEK ... LIC: QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL WELCOMES NEW SURGICAL INTERNS WITH ROOFTOP "DAWN OATH" ...

NY1 ANCHOR (ON TV)
...and in Long Island City this morning, a new class of surgeons-in-training at Queens Grace Hospital takes part in a rooftop tradition dating back to 1968...

MARC
(mouth full, to the TV)
Don't say my name. Don't say my name.

His RAZR buzzes on the counter. A text.

ON THE PHONE SCREEN: FROM: N. "5:30. The roof. Do not be late. I mean it."

ON THE PHONE SCREEN: TO: N. "Never been late a day in my life." SENT 4:57 AM.

He looks at the microwave clock. Puts down the bowl. Sprints.

4 EXT. JACKSON AVENUE - LONG ISLAND CITY - DAWN
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 5:19 AM

Marc runs full speed down Jackson Avenue, white coat flying, under the elevated 7 train. The sky is going pink behind him. On the walls of 5Pointz, graffiti glows in the half light.

Outside a corner dive, MONTY'S ON JACKSON, LAMONT "MONTY" GAINES (42), dapper even at dawn, sweeps the sidewalk.

MONTY
Morning, Doc! You find your way home all right last night?

MARC
(running past)
Didn't go home alone, Monty! I mean... that's not... I'm late!

MONTY
(calling after him)
That's not news, that's a confession!

5 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - THE ROOF - DAWN
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 5:27 AM

Back where we started. The stairwell door BANGS open. Marc stumbles out, breathing hard, tugging his coat straight. Seventeen heads turn.

Natasha looks at him. No recognition. Not a flicker.

NATASHA
Name.

MARC
Bullock. Marc-Anthony Bullock.

NATASHA
Dr. Bullock. You're late.

MARC
By, like... one minute.

NATASHA
By one minute, a patient bleeds out four hundred milliliters. Get in line.

Marc slides into the empty spot... right next to Esther. They both look straight ahead. Then sideways. Recognition hits them both like cold water.

ESTHER
(barely audible)
No.

MARC
(barely audible)
Yeah.

Natasha turns to the class. Behind them the sun breaks the horizon, and across the river the towers of Midtown light up gold, one by one.

NATASHA
In 1889, a woman who was born a slave opened eleven beds in a rowhouse on Vernon Avenue, because every hospital in this city had a door that said "not you." She painted four words over her door, and you are going to say them, and then you are going to spend the rest of your careers earning them.

She looks down the line, into each face.

NATASHA
Some of you will not finish. The ones who do will never be the same.

NATASHA
Repeat after me. Enter.

INTERNS
(ragged)
Enter.

NATASHA
You are welcome here.

INTERNS
You are welcome here.

Harmony is openly crying now. Arianna looks at her sideways.

ARIANNA
(whispering)
Girl. It's a roof.

HARMONY
(whispering, wiping her eyes)
It's a really nice roof.

Natasha nods once to Elxa and walks to the stairwell. She passes Marc without a glance.

NATASHA
(without stopping)
Welcome to Queens Grace, doctors. Don't kill anybody.

The door closes behind her. Esther stares at the skyline. Marc stares at Esther.

MARC (V.O.)
Rule one of being a surgeon: there is no such thing as a small mistake.

MARC (V.O.)
Rule two: you will absolutely make one anyway.

SMASH TO:

MAIN TITLE: MERCY'S ANATOMY

ACT ONE

6 INT. OLD MAIN - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 6:02 AM

Rows of dented green lockers, a flickering fluorescent light, and the smell of industrial disinfectant over 116 years of everything else. Interns change into scrubs, pin on ID badges, and trade rumors.

RAVEN
I heard the residents bet on which of us cries first.

AMOND
Then we have a winner. Juneteenth over there lost it at "enter."

Arianna drops onto the bench, pulling on scrub pants. She looks Esther up and down. Esther is twisting her hair into a bun.

ARIANNA
Hold up. I know you.

ESTHER
You don't.

ARIANNA
I do. A bus shelter in Indianapolis, 2003. Big poster. Hair blowing in a wind that doesn't exist. "Silk Press. Strong Roots."

ESTHER
I paid for medical school. What did you do?

ARIANNA
Loans, like a normal person in debt until I die. Okay, Pantene.

ESTHER
It was a different brand.

ARIANNA
Pantene.

Marc comes in, already in scrubs, and takes the locker next to Amond's.

RAVEN
You're the late one!

MARC
One minute. I'm the one-minute-late one. That should be a separate category.

HARMONY
Who's everybody's resident? I heard there's one they call the Warden.

RAVEN
The Warden?

A clipboard SLAMS against the doorframe. Elxa stands there.

ELXA
Bullock. Baker. Smilley. Divine. Ellison. Hallway. Now.

The five of them scramble. Arianna stays seated, grinning.

ELXA
(to Arianna)
Cummings, you're with Dr. Boykin. Go find him. He's the tall one who looks like he's never slept.

ARIANNA
(standing, sweet)
Quick question. Is there a dress code for smiling? Because you look like you have a policy.

ELXA
For you? You'd need a permit. Go.

Arianna goes, still grinning. Elxa turns and walks. Her five interns follow like ducklings.

7 INT. OLD MAIN - SURGICAL WING CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 6:09 AM

ELXA
I have five rules. Memorize them, because I am not going to repeat them, and I am not going to laminate them.

ELXA
One. Don't suck up. I already hate you. Sucking up only makes me hate you more specifically.

ELXA
Two. When I page you, you run. I don't care if you're asleep, eating, or dying. If you're dying, run slower.

ELXA
Three. You do not lie to me. Ever. Not about a lab value, not about a vital sign, not about whether you washed your hands. If you don't know, say "I don't know," and then go find out.

ELXA
Four. Patients first. Egos never. Your feelings are not on the chart.

ELXA
Five. If I'm operating, you are either holding something or holding still.

She stops so suddenly that Harmony almost walks into her.

ELXA
You're on call. First shift starts now. Federal law says thirty hours, so you get thirty hours and not one minute more, and I will spend every one of those minutes making sure you deserve the next ones.

Elxa looks down at her clipboard. Then up at Marc. A long, cold look.

ELXA
Bullock.

MARC
Bullock.

The other interns look between them. The same name. The same height difference as a fire hydrant and a lamppost.

HARMONY
Wait. Are you two...

ELXA
(instantly)
Common name.

MARC
(instantly)
Super common. Very popular in D.C.

ELXA
Move.

8 INT. OLD MAIN - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 6:31 AM

A sagging couch, a sticky microwave, and a coffee maker that's older than the interns. On the wall hangs THE BOARD: a huge whiteboard of names, rooms and procedures in five colors of marker.

ELXA
Baker. You're in the Pit with Dr. Robert Bullock. Chief of Cardiothoracic.

AMOND
(lit up)
Cardio. Yes. Thank you.

ELXA
Don't thank me. He eats interns. Divine. Room 412, Mr. Lamar Pittman, thirty-four, right lower quadrant pain since midnight. Probable appendicitis. Work him up. If it's an appy, you might get to cut.

HARMONY
(pale)
Cut... like, me? With my hands?

ELXA
Did you plan to use your feet? Ellison. Mrs. Ernestine Pope, eighty-one, gallbladder. She's refusing surgery. Make her un-refuse.

RAVEN
How?

ELXA
Charm. You look like you have some. Smilley. Scut. Rectal exams on the fourth-floor post-ops, discharge paperwork, and the labs I don't feel like chasing.

Esther's jaw tightens. But she nods.

ESTHER
I'm interested in neuro, if there's anything...

ELXA
Then you'll love the nervous system of a rectum. Bullock. Room 419. Destiny Lockhart, seventeen, new-onset seizure last night at a pageant rehearsal. Neuro consult's coming. Babysit her until they clear her.

Amond's head snaps around.

AMOND
A seizure? I'll take the seizure.

ELXA
You're in the Pit.

MARC
(to Amond)
I'll trade you. You take the pageant queen, I take Dr. Eats-Interns.

ELXA
Nobody trades. This is not a lunch table. The Board is the Board.

She caps the marker. Looks at the five of them.

ELXA
One more thing. What you are doing right now, the fighting over cases, the wanting? Keep it. That's the job. Just don't let me catch you wanting it more than you want the patient to live. Go.

They scatter. Amond and Marc end up shoulder to shoulder in the doorway.

AMOND
You stole my seizure.

MARC
She gave me the seizure.

AMOND
Semantics. I'll be watching you, Bullock.

9 INT. PELL PAVILION - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT ("THE PIT") - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 6:52 AM

Controlled chaos: overhead pages, beeping monitors, a toddler wailing in Bay 3. NURSE GLORIA PETTIFORD (53), thirty years in this room, runs it like an air traffic controller.

GLORIA
(to an intern)
Not that bay. That bay's for people who are dying. You look lost. Lost people go in the hallway.

DR. ROBERT BULLOCK (49), immaculate, with a precise mustache and cufflinks peeking from under his scrub sleeves, stands at the central station reading a chart. A cluster of interns from several teams waits near him: Amond, Arianna, two NAMELESS INTERNS... and Marc, passing through with a chart for Room 419.

ROBERT
(without looking up)
The ascending aorta. Name the three layers of its wall.

AMOND
Tunica intima, tunica media, tunica adventitia.

ROBERT
What layer fails in a dissection?

AMOND
The intima tears. Blood dissects into the media and creates a false lumen.

Robert looks up. Studies Amond for a long second.

ROBERT
Name.

AMOND
Baker. Amond Baker. Harvard. I've read all your papers on aortic root replacement, sir. The 1999 one has a typo in figure three.

ROBERT
(dry)
It does. Nobody's ever told me that. (beat) Don't tell me again.

He turns to the group. His eyes find Marc, who's trying to get past with his chart.

ROBERT
You. Tall. What's your name?

MARC
Bullock, sir.

A tiny pause. The Pit noise goes on around them.

ROBERT
Bullock. Any relation?

MARC
(perfectly straight)
Common name, sir.

ROBERT
(perfectly straight)
Is it.

Arianna looks between them, smelling something. She doesn't know what.

ROBERT
Dr. "Common Name." What's the most common cause of new-onset seizure in a seventeen-year-old?

MARC
Idiopathic epilepsy. Then head trauma, drugs, infection, metabolic causes. And then the stuff you lose sleep over. Tumor. Vascular.

ROBERT
Then go find out which one she is, Dr. Common Name.

MARC
Going, sir.

He goes. Robert watches him walk away, just a beat too long. Then he hands Amond a chart.

ROBERT
Bay 6. Fifty-eight-year-old man with chest pain. Everyone thinks he's having a heart attack. Tell me if everyone's wrong.

10 INT. PELL PAVILION - ROOM 419 - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 7:14 AM

A shared room. In bed 2: DESTINY LOCKHART (17), braids up, pageant sash still draped over the chair, a stack of index cards on her lap. Her mother, ROCHELLE LOCKHART (35), a corrections officer in uniform, sits rigid in the visitor's chair.

Marc knocks on the open door.

MARC
Good morning. I'm Dr. Bullock. I'm one of the doctors who's going to be...

DESTINY
(not looking up)
You look twelve.

MARC
I'm twenty-six. I'm a doctor. I have a diploma. It's in Latin. I can't read it, but it's real.

That gets a tiny smile from Destiny. Rochelle doesn't smile.

ROCHELLE
They said a neurologist was coming.

MARC
A neurosurgeon is coming. Dr. Graves. He's the Chief of Neurosurgery. I'm the guy who comes before the guy, so you can yell at me first and save your best yelling for him.

He picks up an index card from her lap.

MARC
"What would you change about the world?"

DESTINY
Miss Teen Queens is tomorrow. That's the interview question. I'm supposed to say "world peace," but everybody says world peace.

MARC
What do you really want to say?

DESTINY
(shrugging)
That nobody in my building should have to take three buses to see a doctor.

MARC
Say that. Win with that.

DR. LELAND GRAVES (52) sweeps in, gray at the temples, reading glasses on a chain, wearing the impatience of a man who's been a genius for thirty years.

GRAVES
Lockhart. Seventeen. Single generalized seizure, no prior history, postictal for twenty minutes, normal now. (to Rochelle) Has she been dieting for this pageant?

ROCHELLE
They all diet.

GRAVES
Low glucose, not enough sleep, dehydration. The classic pageant triad. (to Marc) Head CT, basic metabolic panel, EEG if they can fit her in, and she goes home by noon with a sandwich. Questions?

MARC
Did anyone ask if she hit her head recently?

GRAVES
Do you see a head injury?

MARC
No, sir, but...

GRAVES
Then order the CT, Dr...?

MARC
Bullock.

GRAVES
Then order the CT, Dr. Bullock.

And Graves is gone. Destiny looks at Marc.

DESTINY
He's mean.

MARC
He's busy. Same face, different reason.

11 INT. OLD MAIN - ELEVATOR - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 7:41 AM

An old brass-paneled elevator with a cranky, slow motor. Marc steps in. The doors start to close... and a hand stops them. Esther. She sees him. Considers waiting for the next one. Gets in.

The doors close. The elevator groans upward. Silence.

MARC
So.

ESTHER
Don't.

ESTHER
You said you were starting something big.

MARC
You said you were starting something big.

ESTHER
I didn't think it was the same big.

ESTHER
(turning to him) Last night didn't happen. We're colleagues. We're interns in the same group, under a resident who already hates us both. It can't have happened.

MARC
Okay.

ESTHER
Okay?

MARC
You asked. I respect a request. (beat) For the record, though, it did happen. I was there. It was very nice.

She looks at him. He looks back, completely sincere. That's the problem. He means it.

ESTHER
You live in a mansion.

MARC
It's a brownstone.

ESTHER
It has a fourth floor you're afraid of.

MARC
That's a separate issue.

DING. The doors open. Elxa stands there with a chart, looking at both of them standing too close in a slow elevator.

ELXA
Smilley, your rectums are waiting. Bullock, your CT's in twenty minutes. Why are you two riding the elevator like it's a date?

MARC AND ESTHER
(together)
It's not.

ELXA
(stepping aside)
Rule three.

12 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - BAY 6 - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 8:04 AM

EARL WYNN (58), a retired city bus mechanic, big hands, sweating, chest pain rated "ten" on a whiteboard. A NURSE hooks up an EKG. Amond stands at the bedside with a blood pressure cuff. Arianna lurks at the curtain, eavesdropping.

EARL
It's like somebody's ripping me down the middle. Straight through to my back.

AMOND
When did it start?

EARL
Bending over to tie my shoe. Five-thirty. My wife said it's my heart. My wife's always saying it's my heart.

Amond takes the pressure on the right arm. Then, on instinct, the left. He frowns. Does them again.

AMOND
(to the nurse)
Right arm one fifty-eight over ninety. Left arm one-twenty-two over seventy.

NURSE
So?

AMOND
So that's a thirty-six-point difference between arms. With tearing pain that goes through to the back.

Robert appears at the curtain behind Arianna. She jumps.

ROBERT
Say it.

AMOND
(turning)
I think it's an aortic dissection. Not an MI. If we give him clot-busters, it could kill him.

ROBERT
Your evidence.

AMOND
Tearing pain radiating to the back. Sudden onset with exertion. A blood-pressure difference between the arms. And his EKG doesn't look like an MI.

Robert looks at the EKG strip. Hands it back.

ROBERT
CT angiogram of the chest, now. Call OR 2 and tell them they're going to need it. Nurse, get his pressure down: esmolol drip. Baker.

AMOND
Sir.

ROBERT
If you're right, you're with me. If you're wrong, you never existed.

Robert walks off. Amond exhales for what might be the first time since July 1 started. Arianna stares at him with naked envy.

ARIANNA
How did you know to check the other arm?

AMOND
(cool)
I read.

13 INT. PELL PAVILION - ROOM 506 - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 8:31 AM

A single room full of dignity: a crocheted blanket from home, a Bible, a framed wedding photo from 1946. MRS. ERNESTINE POPE (81), tiny, sharp as a tack, in a satin bonnet, arms crossed. Raven sits on the edge of the visitor's chair with the consent form.

RAVEN
It's a laparoscopic cholecystectomy. Four tiny cuts. The surgeon takes out your gallbladder, which has been trying to kill you for about six months, and you go home in a day or two.

MRS. POPE
No.

RAVEN
Can I ask why?

MRS. POPE
You can ask. (beat) My husband had surgery in this hospital. July 13th, 1977.

RAVEN
(counting)
The blackout?

MRS. POPE
Lights went out all over the city. Generator died in the middle of his bowel surgery. They finished it by flashlight. A nurse held a lamp from the lobby over him for two hours while the city burned outside.

RAVEN
And did he...?

MRS. POPE
He lived twenty-six more years. Died in 2003 in his recliner, watching the Mets lose.

RAVEN
(confused)
Then... why won't you...?

MRS. POPE
Because I don't have a lamp. And I don't have him. I'm eighty-one years old, baby. Every time I've been brave, it's because Herbert was holding my hand. So, no.

Raven looks at the consent form. Then at the wedding photo. She folds the form in half and puts it in her pocket.

RAVEN
Okay. Then I'll come back.

MRS. POPE
I'll still say no.

RAVEN
Then I'll keep coming back. I'm very annoying. My grandma says it's my best quality.

14 INT. PELL PAVILION - 4TH FLOOR CORRIDOR - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 9:12 AM

Marc walks beside a wheelchair as a TRANSPORTER pushes Destiny back from CT. She's practicing her interview answers under her breath. Rochelle walks on the other side.

MARC
CT's clean. No bleeding, no tumor. That's good news.

ROCHELLE
So she can go home?

MARC
Dr. Graves will decide. But it's looking...

DESTINY
(practicing)
"What I'd change about the world is that nobody in my building should have to..."

She stops mid-sentence. Her eyes drift up and to the right. Her hand begins to twitch.

MARC
Destiny?

Her whole body goes rigid. Then it begins to jerk. A full generalized seizure, right in the wheelchair. Rochelle screams. The transporter freezes.

MARC
(instantly calm)
Lock the chair. Help me get her down. On her side, on her side.

Marc lowers her to the floor, one big hand cradling her head so it doesn't hit the tile. Her index cards scatter across the hallway like confetti.

MARC
(to the nurses' station)
I need lorazepam, two milligrams IV, and somebody page Dr. Graves STAT. Nobody puts anything in her mouth!

Rochelle drops to her knees beside her daughter. Marc keeps his hand under Destiny's head, eyes on his watch, counting the seconds.

MARC
(quiet, to Destiny)
I got you. I got you. You're okay. I got you.

Esther rounds the corner with a stack of discharge papers. She stops dead and watches him: steady, gentle, completely in command.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

15 INT. PELL PAVILION - ROOM 419 - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 9:31 AM

Destiny is back in bed, groggy and postictal, an IV in her arm. Rochelle holds her hand. Graves reads the CT on a lightbox in the doorway, irritated. Marc stands beside him.

GRAVES
Two seizures, a clean CT. Could be a primary seizure disorder. Load her with Keppra, get the EEG, and refer her to outpatient neurology.

MARC
Dr. Graves, two seizures in twelve hours in a kid with no history...

GRAVES
...is a kid with a new seizure disorder. It happens. Epilepsy is not a mystery novel, Dr. Bullock.

MARC
What if it's vascular? A CT can miss a small...

GRAVES
A CT can miss a lot of things. So can an intern who's been a doctor for four hours. (beat) You want an angiogram on a seventeen-year-old? An invasive procedure, a catheter up through her femoral artery and into her brain, with a real stroke risk, because you have a feeling?

MARC
It's not a feeling. It's... okay, it's a feeling right now.

GRAVES
Then find me a reason, Bullock. A real one. Or discharge her on Keppra with a referral. Your choice.

Graves leaves. Marc turns. Esther is in the doorway, discharge papers against her chest.

ESTHER
He's not wrong. Two seizures, clean CT. Keppra and an EEG is the textbook answer.

MARC
You think she has epilepsy?

ESTHER
(beat)
...No.

MARC
Why not?

ESTHER
Because her seizure started with her eyes deviating up and to the right. That means it has a focus. It started somewhere specific. Idiopathic generalized seizures don't usually look like that.

MARC
(grinning)
You want neuro.

ESTHER
I said I was interested.

MARC
You watched her eyes. While she was seizing. While I was busy holding her head and panicking on the inside.

ESTHER
(softening)
You didn't look like you were panicking.

MARC
That's my best trick. Help me find the reason.

She hesitates. Looks at the scut list in her hand: twenty rectal exams. Then at Destiny.

ESTHER
Get her history. The whole thing. Not the chart version. The real version. Kids don't tell attendings anything. They might tell you.

MARC
Why me?

ESTHER
Because you look twelve.

16 INT. OLD MAIN - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 10:34 AM

The TV on the wall plays CNN. Harmony sits on the couch, frozen, staring at an anatomy atlas open to the appendix. Arianna eats peanut butter crackers out of a vending machine pack.

ON THE TV: CNN BREAKING NEWS. "JUSTICE O'CONNOR RETIRES. First woman on the Supreme Court announces she will step down." The crawl: "...letter to President Bush delivered this morning..."

ARIANNA
(re: the TV)
See, that's how you leave. Twenty-four years, then a letter. No crying on a roof.

HARMONY
Dr. Bullock... the girl Dr. Bullock... said if it's an appy, I might get to cut. Today. On a human man.

ARIANNA
Where's the appendix?

HARMONY
McBurney's point. A third of the way from the anterior superior iliac spine to the umbilicus.

ARIANNA
Where's it actually?

HARMONY
(slowly)
...Anywhere it wants. Retrocecal, pelvic, subhepatic...

ARIANNA
So you're gonna cut a man open looking for a little worm that could be anywhere it wants. Good luck, Juneteenth.

Harmony shuts the book and puts her head on it.

HARMONY
(muffled)
Why are you so mean?

ARIANNA
(genuinely considering it)
Gary, Indiana.

17 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 10:52 AM

A big OR: blue drapes, the steady wheeze of the ventilator, the bypass machine humming. JOHN COLTRANE'S "A LOVE SUPREME" plays low from a boombox on a shelf.

Earl Wynn's chest is open. Robert operates with total calm, his hands precise. SCRUB NURSE YVETTE BANKS (41) passes instruments before he asks for them. Amond, gowned and gloved, holds a retractor in a death grip, watching like it's the Super Bowl.

ROBERT
Type A dissection. Starts in the ascending aorta, right above the valve. If you'd given him tPA in the Pit, Dr. Baker, he would have bled into his chest and died before lunch.

AMOND
Yes, sir.

ROBERT
Do you know what you did right?

AMOND
I checked the other arm.

ROBERT
You checked the other arm because you didn't trust the easy answer. (beat) Yvette, Dacron graft. Twenty-eight.

Yvette hands it over. Robert begins sewing the graft in place, stitch after perfect stitch.

ROBERT
Your retractor. Two degrees toward me.

Amond adjusts by exactly two degrees.

ROBERT
Hm.

ROBERT
Your hands are steady. Don't let it go to your head. It's attached to them.

Amond tries to hide a smile behind his mask and fails. Coltrane's saxophone climbs.

AMOND
Dr. Bullock, can I ask why Coltrane?

ROBERT
Because Coltrane practiced twelve hours a day until he didn't have to think. That's what surgery is. (beat) And because the anesthesiologist hates it.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
(from behind the drape)
I really do.

18 INT. PELL PAVILION - ROOM 412 - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 11:33 AM

LAMAR PITTMAN (34), a lean MTA track worker, lies curled on his side, sweating, an orange MTA safety vest folded on the chair. Harmony palpates his abdomen. He winces.

HARMONY
Pain when I press here?

PITTMAN
Pain when you look at it.

HARMONY
And when I let go?

She presses deep in the right lower quadrant, then releases suddenly. Pittman almost comes off the bed.

PITTMAN
OH. Okay, I'm not loving you right now, Doc.

HARMONY
That's rebound tenderness. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. It's very helpful.

She looks at the vest.

HARMONY
You work for the MTA?

PITTMAN
Track maintenance. The 7 line. Twelve years.

HARMONY
My daddy drives the Q4. Thirty-one years. Howard Divine.

PITTMAN
(lighting up despite the pain)
Big Howard? Laughs like a car alarm? He drove me to Jamaica High every morning for four years!

HARMONY
(laughing)
That's him! That's my daddy!

PITTMAN
(wincing)
So what's wrong with me, Big Howard's daughter?

HARMONY
Your white count's sixteen thousand, you have rebound tenderness, and your ultrasound shows an inflamed appendix. You need it out. Today.

PITTMAN
Are you doing it?

Harmony opens her mouth. Closes it.

HARMONY
I'll be... there. Very there.

19 INT. OLD MAIN - LOBBY - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 12:11 PM

The grand Art Deco lobby: marble floors, a brass clock, and a bronze WALL OF GRACE with names engraved from 1918 to 2001. In a glass case on a pedestal sits LOCKWOOD'S LAMP, an 1889 brass oil lamp, lit.

Raven wheels Mrs. Pope across the lobby and stops in front of the case.

RAVEN
Is this the lamp?

Mrs. Pope doesn't answer at first. She leans forward and puts her hand on the glass.

MRS. POPE
(quietly)
That's the lamp.

RAVEN
A nurse named Hannah Lockwood carried it in 1889. They keep it lit all the time now. They say it flickers before something bad happens.

MRS. POPE
Does it?

RAVEN
(honestly)
It's on a timer. (beat) Mostly.

Mrs. Pope laughs, a real one.

MRS. POPE
The girl who held that lamp over Herbert was about your age. Shaking like a leaf. But she didn't put it down. Two hours, and she didn't put it down.

RAVEN
I don't have a lamp, Mrs. Pope. But I have hands. And you can hold one of them in pre-op, all the way until you're asleep. I'll be right there.

A long silence. Mrs. Pope looks at the lamp. Then at Raven.

MRS. POPE
Give me the paper.

Raven pulls the folded consent form from her pocket. Mrs. Pope signs it on her knee in elegant, old-fashioned cursive.

MRS. POPE
Tomorrow morning. And you'd better be there, Savannah.

RAVEN
How did you know I'm from Savannah?

MRS. POPE
Baby, you say "y'all" like it's two syllables.

20 INT. OLD MAIN - CAFETERIA - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 12:47 PM

Noise and fluorescent light. MISS HATTIE LOMAX (60), a hairnet, a ladle and the authority of a supreme court, runs the hot line. A handwritten sign: "FISH FRIDAY. NO SUBSTITUTIONS. NO, NOT EVEN FOR YOU, DOCTOR."

The interns crowd one table: Marc, Raven, Harmony, Esther, Arianna. Trays of fried whiting, greens and cornbread.

MISS HATTIE
(dropping an extra piece of fish on Harmony's tray)
You look like you need it, baby.

Elxa comes through with a tray. She gets a whiff of the fish, goes a little green and walks straight past the table.

RAVEN
Is she okay?

MARC
(watching her go, a flicker of concern)
She's... she doesn't like fish. I'm guessing. Everyone has things.

RAVEN
(to Marc)
So I've been in a sublet in Ridgewood for five days and the guy who rents it to me plays the clarinet at 2 AM. Harmony lives with her mother.

HARMONY
My mother is lovely.

RAVEN
Her mother calls her pager. Not her cell. Her pager.

RAVEN
(pointedly, to Marc)
Esther says you live in a mansion.

Esther chokes on her cornbread. Marc turns slowly to look at her.

ESTHER
I said "big house." Generally. In the locker room. Not... specifically. Because I heard. From someone.

ARIANNA
(delighted)
Pantene's been to the mansion.

ESTHER
It's a brownstone.

ARIANNA
She knows it's a brownstone!

Amond drops into the last chair at the table, still in his OR cap, eyes enormous.

AMOND
I held an aorta.

MARC
You did what?

AMOND
Robert Bullock let me hold the retractor while he put in a graft. It's the most important vessel in the human body. Whose patient did I diagnose? Mine. Who checked the other arm? Me.

ARIANNA
He's gonna be insufferable now.

AMOND
I was always insufferable. Now I'm validated.

Marc grins and holds up his hand for a high five. Amond looks at it like a foreign object. Then slaps it, awkwardly.

AMOND
Don't make that a thing.

MARC
It's already a thing.

21 INT. PELL PAVILION - ROOM 419 - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 1:32 PM

Destiny is awake now, tired, painting her nails a pageant pink because she refuses to be a patient. Marc pulls up a chair backward and sits on it like he's in a barbershop.

MARC
Okay. Forget the chart. Tell me everything weird that's happened in the last month.

DESTINY
Weird how?

MARC
Any kind of weird. Body weird. Brain weird. You fell down. You threw up. You got a headache that made you see God.

Destiny keeps painting. Then stops.

DESTINY
I fell off a riser. At rehearsal. Like, three weeks ago. Hit my head on the stage.

ROCHELLE
(from the chair)
You didn't tell me that.

DESTINY
You'd have made me quit.

MARC
Did you get knocked out?

DESTINY
Just dizzy. And then... last week, Thursday maybe, I got this headache. The worst one ever. Like somebody hit me with a bat from the inside. It came out of nowhere. I threw up in the bathroom at the Y.

Marc goes very still.

MARC
The worst headache of your life. Sudden. Out of nowhere.

DESTINY
(nodding)
And then it just... went away. So I didn't say anything.

Marc turns to Rochelle.

MARC
Ms. Lockhart, it says in her chart that you had a kidney transplant. What was the kidney disease?

ROCHELLE
Polycystic. P-K-D. My mother had it, my uncle had it. I got my kidney in 1999.

A beat. You can see the pieces click together behind Marc's eyes.

MARC
Autosomal dominant polycystic kidney disease.

ROCHELLE
Is that bad?

MARC
It means there's a fifty percent chance she inherited it. And people with PKD have a much higher risk of something called a berry aneurysm in the brain. It's a weak spot in a blood vessel that balloons out.

Rochelle's hand goes to her mouth.

MARC
(gently, quickly)
I don't know that she has one. But a sudden worst-ever headache could be a sentinel bleed, a little leak, and the seizures could be the brain reacting. A CT can miss a small bleed after this many days. I need to look. Can I look?

22 INT. PELL PAVILION - 4TH FLOOR NURSES' STATION - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 1:46 PM

Marc on the phone at the nurses' station, pager in his other hand.

MARC
(into the phone)
...yes, a sentinel headache ten days ago, minor head trauma three weeks ago, a mother with ADPKD and probably a family history of it, a focal-onset seizure with eye deviation, and a CT that's too late to catch a small bleed. I'm asking for a CT angiogram and a lumbar puncture... yes, sir... yes, sir, I understand that... thank you, sir.

He hangs up. Turns. Elxa is standing right behind him, arms folded.

ELXA
Who was that?

MARC
Dr. Graves.

ELXA
You paged the Chief of Neurosurgery.

MARC
He told me to find him a reason. I found him a reason.

ELXA
Without paging me.

MARC
(realizing)
...Without paging you.

ELXA
Rule two. When I page you, you run. Do you know what the unwritten rule is underneath rule two? You page ME. Before you page God. I am your resident. You are my intern. If you go over my head and you're wrong, it's my name on the chart. If you go over my head and you're right, it's still my name on the chart, and I didn't know why.

MARC
I'm sorry. I got excited. It's a really good reason.

ELXA
(beat)
Is it?

MARC
(all in)
It's the best reason I've ever had.

Elxa studies him. For a fraction of a second, something that might be pride. Gone.

ELXA
Then you'd better be right, Bullock. Because if you sent a seventeen-year-old for an angiogram because you "got excited," Graves will eat you, and I'll help.

23 INT. PELL PAVILION - NEURO-INTERVENTIONAL SUITE - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 3:12 PM

Dark room, glowing monitors. Destiny lies sedated on the table. The CT angiogram was positive, so Graves has moved her straight to a diagnostic cerebral angiogram. He feeds a catheter up from her femoral artery. Marc, in a lead apron, watches the screen. Elxa watches from the doorway, arms folded.

GRAVES
Contrast.

The TECH injects. On the monitor, the arteries of Destiny's brain light up like a black-and-white river map... and there, at the anterior communicating artery, a small, round, unmistakable bulge.

GRAVES
(quietly)
Well. Damn.

TECH
Seven millimeters. Anterior communicating artery. Wide neck.

Graves rotates the image. Studies it. Then turns and looks at Marc over his glasses, as if seeing him for the first time.

GRAVES
A seven-millimeter aneurysm with a sentinel bleed, in a seventeen-year-old with familial PKD, which nobody asked about until you did. If she'd gone home on Keppra tonight, this would have ruptured in her sleep or on a stage, and she would have died.

Marc can't speak.

GRAVES
Congratulations, Dr. Bullock. You just saved a beauty queen's life.

Marc lets out a breath. Graves holds up a finger.

GRAVES
Don't get excited. She's not saved yet. That's surgery.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

24 INT. PELL PAVILION - DR. GRAVES'S OFFICE - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 3:41 PM

Books, a framed photo with a Nobel laureate, and an angiogram on the lightbox. Graves, Elxa, and Marc.

GRAVES
The neck's too wide to coil safely. I'll clip it. Open craniotomy, pterional approach. Tonight, seven o'clock. If it re-bleeds before then, we lose her.

ELXA
I'll get the consent and book the OR.

GRAVES
I want an intern scrubbed.

ELXA
Baker scrubbed this morning on the dissection, but he's fast, he's...

GRAVES
Not Baker. The one who found it.

Elxa's jaw tightens. A long pause.

ELXA
Dr. Graves, it's his first day. It's a ruptured...

GRAVES
A sentinel bleed. Not ruptured yet. And I didn't say he'd operate. I said he'd scrub. He'll hold suction and keep his mouth shut, and he'll learn what saving a life actually looks like. (to Marc) Can you keep your mouth shut?

MARC
Historically? No, sir. But tonight I'll try.

GRAVES
(almost amused)
Seven o'clock.

25 INT. PELL PAVILION - CORRIDOR OUTSIDE NEURO - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 3:56 PM

Marc comes out of the office walking on air, straight into Amond and Esther, who've obviously heard.

AMOND
You got the aneurysm.

MARC
I got the aneurysm.

Esther stands back a little. Marc turns to her.

MARC
Esther, you saw the eye deviation. You told me to get the real history. This is half yours. I'm going to tell Graves...

ESTHER
Don't.

MARC
Why?

ESTHER
Because I was doing rectal exams. That's my day. You got the brain. (beat) Congratulations. Really.

She means it, mostly. It still costs her. She walks away. Marc watches her go. Amond watches Marc watching her.

AMOND
Oh, no.

MARC
What?

AMOND
You have a thing.

MARC
I don't have a thing.

AMOND
You have a thing with Pantene.

MARC
Don't call her that.

AMOND
(filing it away)
Oh, you REALLY have a thing.

26 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 4 - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 4:33 PM

A smaller OR. Lamar Pittman, under anesthesia, his abdomen prepped and draped. Harmony, gowned and gloved, stands at the table holding a scalpel like it's a live grenade. Elxa stands across from her. Above them, behind the glass of THE GALLERY, Arianna and two other interns have their faces nearly pressed to the window.

ELXA
Transverse incision over McBurney's point. Four centimeters. Go.

Harmony makes the incision. Clean. Good. She exhales.

ELXA
Good. Now the external oblique. Split along the fibers. Don't cut across them.

Harmony works through the layers, slowly, carefully. Into the peritoneum. She reaches in, feeling for the cecum.

HARMONY
I've got the cecum. I'm following the taenia down to the base of the... the base...

She feels around. Her face changes.

HARMONY
I can't find it.

ELXA
It's there. Follow the taenia.

HARMONY
I'm following it. It's not... it's not where it's supposed to be.

ELXA
Then it's retrocecal. Mobilize the cecum. Gently.

Harmony mobilizes. There's a gush of blood. She's torn a small vessel in the mesoappendix. Blood wells up in the wound. Harmony freezes. Her hands start to shake.

ELXA
Suction. Divine. Suction. Put pressure on it.

Harmony doesn't move. She stares at the blood.

ELXA
DIVINE.

Nothing. Elxa moves in fluidly, takes the instruments, clamps the bleeder, ties it off and delivers the appendix up into the wound in about forty seconds flat.

ELXA
(calm now)
Retrocecal. Inflamed, not perforated. He's fine.

In the gallery, Arianna slowly begins a sarcastic golf clap. Behind the mask, Harmony's eyes fill.

ELXA
(without looking up)
Divine. Step back from the table.

27 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 4 SCRUB ROOM - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 5:22 PM

Harmony scrubs her hands at the sink, over and over, long past clean. Arianna leans in the doorway.

ARIANNA
Licensed to kill.

HARMONY
Leave me alone.

ARIANNA
Double-O Divine. Licensed to kill. That's your name now. It'll be on the bathroom wall by tomorrow.

HARMONY
(spinning around)
I froze, okay? I froze. I've wanted to do this since I was nine. I sat in a pew every Sunday and prayed to God to let me be a surgeon, and the first time He let me, I froze.

Arianna, for one second, isn't laughing.

ARIANNA
(quieter)
Everybody freezes once.

HARMONY
Did you?

ARIANNA
(beat)
I'm not telling you that.
(pushing off the doorframe)
Double-O.

She's gone. Harmony turns back to the sink, alone. She turns off the water. Takes a breath.

HARMONY
(to herself)
He's fine. Mr. Pittman is fine.

28 INT. PELL PAVILION - ROOM 419 - DAY
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 6:15 PM

Pre-op. Destiny's braids are tucked under a surgical cap. They'll shave only a strip. Her sash is folded on Rochelle's lap. Marc sits on the edge of the bed.

DESTINY
They're gonna shave my head.

MARC
A little strip. Behind the hairline. It'll grow back.

DESTINY
Will I be able to do the pageant?

MARC
Not tomorrow.

DESTINY
(eyes filling)
I've been practicing for a year.

MARC
I know. And I'm not gonna lie to you, because I promised my boss I'd never lie, and she scares me. You're not walking that stage tomorrow. (beat) But next year you are. And you're gonna answer the question about the buses, and you're gonna win.

DESTINY
You don't know that.

MARC
I know you. A little. Since this morning. That counts.

DESTINY
Will you be in there? In the surgery?

MARC
I'll be right there the whole time. I'm holding the suction. That's the vacuum. It's a very important vacuum. Basically, I'm the janitor of your brain.

Destiny laughs through the tears. Rochelle, who hasn't smiled all day, smiles.

ROCHELLE
(to Marc)
You got kids?

MARC
Not yet. Someday. A lot of them. Like, an unreasonable number.

ROCHELLE
You'd be good at it.

Marc looks down at that. It means more than she knows.

29 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 1 SCRUB ROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 6:53 PM

Marc and Graves scrub side by side at the long steel sink. Through the window into OR 1, they can see Destiny being

positioned, her head in a three-pin Mayfield clamp.

GRAVES
How long have you known you wanted neurosurgery?

MARC
I don't. I want pediatric surgery.

GRAVES
(surprised)
Then why fight this hard for a neuro case?

MARC
Because she's a kid. It doesn't matter what kind of surgery a kid needs. It matters that somebody fights for them.

Graves considers that. Rinses his arms.

GRAVES
And if this thing ruptures before I get a clip on it, the field will fill with blood in about four seconds, and I'll need to see. If I can't see, she dies. Your entire job tonight is to make sure I can see.

MARC
(swallowing)
Make sure you can see.

They back through the doors into the OR, hands raised.

30 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 1 - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 7:48 PM

The operating microscope looms over the table. On a monitor, a magnified view of the brain: pink, glistening, the delicate vessels at its base. Yvette at the instrument tray. An ANESTHESIOLOGIST at the head.

Behind the glass of the gallery, the audience has grown: Amond, Esther, Raven, Harmony, two nurses, and in the back row, alone, Elxa.

GRAVES
Splitting the sylvian fissure.
Suction, Dr. Bullock. Gentle.
Low.

Marc moves the suction tip, steady, keeping the field clear. Graves works with micro-instruments, opening the tissue a millimeter at a time.

GRAVES
There. The anterior communicating complex. And there's our friend.

On the monitor, the aneurysm: a thin-walled red dome, pulsing with each heartbeat.

GRAVES
Look at that wall. It's like wet tissue paper. One more week and it would have... Yvette, temporary clip.

Graves reaches in with the temporary clip to stop blood flow into the aneurysm.

GRAVES
Easy... easy...

As the clip approaches, the dome trembles... and BURSTS. Blood erupts into the field. In one second the monitor is solid red.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
Pressure's dropping!

GRAVES
(calm, steel)
Intraoperative rupture. Suction, Bullock. Now.

In the gallery, Esther's hand flies to the glass. Amond goes rigid. Harmony grabs Raven's arm.

GRAVES
BULLOCK. I CAN'T SEE.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

31 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 1 - CONTINUOUS
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 7:49 PM

Blood fills the field. Marc's suction tip goes in. Two seconds of panic in his eyes. Then he steadies, like flipping a switch.

MARC
(quiet, to himself)
Make sure he can see.

He works the suction in a smooth, controlled rhythm, clearing blood just long enough for the anatomy to flash through.

GRAVES
Left. Left. Deeper. There. Hold it there. Don't move.

Marc holds it. His big hands are perfectly, impossibly still. The field clears for one second.

GRAVES
Permanent clip. Now.

Yvette slaps the clip applier into Graves's hand. He reaches in... and clamps it across the neck of the aneurysm.

The bleeding stops. The field goes clear. On the monitor, the collapsed dome sits behind the clip like a deflated balloon.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
Pressure's coming back.
One-oh-eight over sixty.
One-fifteen.

Silence in the OR. Graves lets out a long breath behind his mask.

GRAVES
(quietly)
Clip's on. She's okay.

In the gallery, Raven bursts into tears. Harmony hugs her. Amond puts both hands on his head.

Esther presses her forehead to the glass and closes her eyes. Elxa, in the back row, doesn't move. But her hand,

gripping the back of a chair, slowly unclenches.

GRAVES
(not looking at Marc)
You didn't move.

MARC
You said not to.

GRAVES
People hear that. They don't do it. (beat) Yvette, we'll close. Dr. Bullock, you'll watch me close the dura.

MARC
Yes, sir.

GRAVES
And then you'll place one staple. One. In the scalp.

MARC
(grinning behind his mask)
Yes, sir.

32 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 1 GALLERY - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 8:31 PM

Most of the crowd has gone. Esther and Amond sit in the front row of the gallery, watching Graves close below them. Marc stands at the table, ramrod straight, waiting for his staple like it's Christmas morning.

AMOND
He didn't move.

ESTHER
I saw.

ESTHER
He's good.

AMOND
He's annoying.

ESTHER
(smiling slightly)
He's both.

Down below, Graves hands Marc the stapler. Marc places one perfect staple in Destiny's scalp. He looks up at the

gallery and gives a tiny, ridiculous thumbs-up.

Amond groans. Esther laughs before she can stop herself.

33 INT. PELL PAVILION - SURGICAL FAMILY WAITING ROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 10:14 PM

A beige room with a television on mute and a vending machine that hums. Rochelle sits alone in her uniform, holding the folded sash. Marc enters, still in his scrub cap. She stands so fast her chair scrapes.

MARC
She's out of surgery. The aneurysm bled during the operation. That can happen. But Dr. Graves got the clip on, and the bleeding stopped. She's in the neuro ICU. She'll be asleep for a while. The next forty-eight hours matter, but right now? She's okay.

Rochelle grabs him and holds on. She's a big, strong woman and she squeezes like she's trying to make sure he's real.

ROCHELLE
(muffled into his shoulder)
You said you'd be right there.

MARC
I was right there.

She lets go. Wipes her face. Pulls herself back into her uniform posture.

ROCHELLE
I'm a C.O. at Rikers. Twenty years. People lie to me all day long. (beat) You didn't lie to me once.

MARC
Not today. Ask me tomorrow, maybe I'll lie about my age.

34 INT. PELL PAVILION - ROOM 506 - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 10:43 PM

Mrs. Pope, in her bonnet, watching the late news on a tiny TV. Raven comes in with a cup of ice chips.

RAVEN
Six AM tomorrow. Dr. Boykin's doing it, with an attending. I'll be there in pre-op.

MRS. POPE
You'd better.

Mrs. Pope reaches over and pats Raven's hand.

MRS. POPE
You remind me of that nurse. Shaking like a leaf, and you didn't put it down.

RAVEN
(moved)
I didn't do anything. I just kept coming back.

MRS. POPE
Baby, that's the whole thing. That's all it ever was.

35 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005 - 11:22 PM

The Pit at night: louder, stranger. A drunk singing "Before I Let Go" in Bay 2, a construction worker with a nail gun injury. Marc stands at the central station, finally writing his notes.

Natasha walks through the Pit, as she does every night she's here late. Staff straighten as she passes. She stops next to Marc. Professional. Cool.

NATASHA
Dr. Bullock.

MARC
(straightening)
Chief.

NATASHA
I hear you found an aneurysm today.

MARC
Dr. Graves found it, Chief.

NATASHA
That's not what Dr. Graves says. Dr. Graves says you found it, went over your resident's head to tell him about it, and then held the suction during an intraoperative rupture like you'd been doing it for twenty years.

MARC
(beat)
I did go over her head. That was wrong.

NATASHA
Yes, it was. (beat) Don't do it again.

MARC
No, ma'am.

She holds his gaze for a moment longer than a Chief needs to. Then she moves on. Gloria watches her go. Then watches Marc. Then goes back to her chart, with the slightest frown.

Across the Pit, Natasha passes Elxa. They don't speak. They don't even slow down. But Natasha's hand brushes Elxa's elbow as she passes, a gesture so small nobody would notice. Nobody but us.

36 INT. PELL PAVILION - 4TH FLOOR - ON-CALL ROOM 4C - NIGHT
SATURDAY, JULY 2, 2005 - 12:06 AM

A tiny room: two bunks, a blackout curtain, and a door with a lock that hasn't worked since 1994. Marc opens the door, exhausted, ready to collapse... and Esther is sitting on the bottom bunk with her shoes off.

MARC
Oh... sorry, the sign said...

ESTHER
The lock's broken. It's been broken since 1994. A nurse told me. It's kind of famous.

MARC
I'll find another room.

ESTHER
Stay. Sit. I'm not... it's fine.

He sits on the floor with his back against the opposite wall, his legs so long they almost reach her bunk. For a moment, just two exhausted people.

ESTHER
You were incredible tonight.

MARC
I was terrified.

ESTHER
I know. That's what was incredible.

Beat.

MARC
I'm sorry about the neuro case. You wanted it. You saw the eyes. You should have been in there.

ESTHER
(shaking her head)
You were the one who asked her about the riser. I'd have read the chart. You talked to her like a person. (beat) I came to New York to start over, Marc. Completely. New city, new everything. I can't start over with... something. Already. On day one.

MARC
Okay.

ESTHER
You keep saying "okay."

MARC
Because you keep being right, and I keep wishing you weren't.

She looks at him. He looks at her. The room is very small. She leans down toward him. He leans up, just slightly. They're very close.

His pager goes off. They both jump. He checks it.

MARC
(reading)
Room 412 wants a Tylenol order for Mr. Pittman.

ESTHER
(laughing softly, pulling back)
Go. Go save Mr. Pittman from his headache.

He gets up. At the door he stops.

MARC
For the record...

ESTHER
I know. It happened. You were there.

MARC
I was there.

He goes. Esther lies back on the bunk and stares at the slats of the bunk above her. Her hand drifts to her collarbone, where something hangs on a thin chain under her scrub top. She holds it.

37 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - THE ROOF - NIGHT
SATURDAY, JULY 2, 2005 - 12:41 AM

The roof again, at night now. The skyline glitters across the river, and the Pepsi-Cola sign hums red below. Amond sits on an air-conditioning unit eating vending-machine peanut butter crackers. Marc comes up with two cans of ginger ale and hands him one.

AMOND
You're stalking me.

MARC
You're on my roof.

AMOND
It's the hospital's roof.

MARC
I said the oath first.

AMOND
You were late for the oath.

Marc sits down next to him. They look out at Manhattan.

AMOND
My father died when I was nine. Car accident. I was in the back seat. He was bleeding, and I didn't know what to do, so I held his hand and talked about the Lakers, and he died while I was talking about the Lakers.

Marc turns to look at him. Amond keeps staring at the skyline.

AMOND
I'm telling you this so you understand. When I see a case, I don't want it. I NEED it. I have to be the one who knows what to do. Always. So when you take a case from me, it's not personal.

MARC
(quietly)
It's personal.

AMOND
It's a little personal.

Marc nods slowly. Then he holds out his fist.

MARC
From now on, when one of us gets the case, the other one's in the gallery. Every time. So neither of us is ever the only one in the room who knows what to do.

Amond looks at the fist for a long time.

AMOND
That's corny.

MARC
So corny.

Amond bumps it.

MARC
You're my day one, Baker.

AMOND
Don't make it weird.

MARC
It's already weird.

AMOND
(beat, almost smiling)
It's a little weird.

38 INT. PELL PAVILION - 4TH FLOOR CORRIDOR - NIGHT
SATURDAY, JULY 2, 2005 - 1:16 AM

Marc comes out of Room 412 having written a Tylenol order. Raven and Harmony are waiting for him in the hallway like an ambush.

RAVEN
Seven bedrooms.

MARC
Who told you that?

RAVEN
Amond. Amond knows everything. He's like a bad search engine.

HARMONY
Here's the thing. I'm twenty-six, and I have never not lived with my mother. Tonight she's paged me eleven times. Eleven. One page just said "????". And I love her, I love her so much, but I froze in surgery today, and I think part of it is that I've never, ever been on my own.

HARMONY
We'd pay rent!

RAVEN
We'd pay rent. Small rent. Intern rent.

Marc grins. That big, easy, dimpled grin.

MARC
Four hundred a month. And groceries.

RAVEN
That's it?

MARC
That's it. Don't negotiate. I'll go down.

Harmony throws her arms around him. Raven joins in. Marc stands there being hugged in the hallway.

His pager goes off. He looks at it. His face changes.

ON THE PAGER SCREEN: "CHIEF'S OFFICE. NOW. -- E.B."

HARMONY
What is it?

MARC
(pocketing the pager)
Nothing. I'm probably getting fired. Same time tomorrow?

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

39 INT. PELL PAVILION - NEURO ICU - NIGHT
SATURDAY, JULY 2, 2005 - 1:31 AM

Dim lights, the steady beep of monitors. Destiny lies with her head bandaged, groggy, waking. A NURSE checks her pupils. Marc stops at the door on his way to the Chief's office. He can't help himself.

NURSE
She's been asking for "the tall one."

He goes to the bedside.

MARC
Hey, Miss Teen Queens.

DESTINY
(slurred, smiling)
You're... the janitor.

MARC
I'm the janitor. Squeeze my fingers.

She squeezes with both hands. He checks her feet: she wiggles her toes. He shines a light. Pupils are equal.

MARC
Everything works. You're perfect.

DESTINY
Did I win?

MARC
(gently)
The pageant's tomorrow. You're gonna miss it.

DESTINY
(drowsy)
Next year.

MARC
Next year.

DESTINY
Will you come?

MARC
Front row. I'll make a sign.
It'll be embarrassing.

She's asleep again, smiling. Marc stands there a moment longer. Then he goes.

40 INT. OLD MAIN - LOBBY - NIGHT
SATURDAY, JULY 2, 2005 - 1:44 AM

The marble lobby at night: quiet and enormous. OLIVER "OLLIE" FREEMAN (56), the night custodian, polishes the glass of Lockwood's Lamp. RAYMOND "BIG RAY" TOLES (45), chief of security, six-foot-seven, sits at the front desk with a crossword.

As Marc crosses the lobby, the lamp's flame flickers.

Marc stops. Stares at it.

MARC
Did it just...

BIG RAY
(not looking up from the crossword)
Timer, Doc.

MARC
Oh. Okay.

OLLIE
(still polishing)
Mostly.

Marc looks at the lamp. Then at the two of them. Then he takes the stairs, two at a time.

41 INT. OLD MAIN - 9TH FLOOR - OUTSIDE THE CHIEF'S OFFICE - NIGHT
SATURDAY, JULY 2, 2005 - 1:48 AM

A dark outer office. On the assistant's desk, a nameplate reads BERNADETTE WATKINS. Next to it is a framed photo, face down. Marc stops at the closed door with the frosted glass and gold letters: CHIEF OF SURGERY.

He takes a breath. He knocks.

NATASHA (O.S.)
Come in.

42 INT. OLD MAIN - CHIEF OF SURGERY'S OFFICE - NIGHT
SATURDAY, JULY 2, 2005 - 1:49 AM

A corner office with windows on two sides, the Manhattan skyline filling them like a painting. Diplomas. A photo of a much younger Natasha in scrubs at Brigham and Women's. Natasha stands at the window with her shoes off and her heels in her hand.

MARC
Chief.

NATASHA
(not turning)
Door.

He closes it. A long pause. She turns around, crosses the room... and puts her arms around him. She has to reach up to do it.

NATASHA
(soft)
Hi, baby.

Marc melts into the hug like he's six years old.

MARC
Hi, Mommy.

NATASHA
(pulling back, holding his face)
You were late.

MARC
One minute.

The door opens without a knock. Elxa comes in, pager in hand, still furious.

ELXA
Mom. He paged the Chief of Neurosurgery over my head. On his first day.

NATASHA
I know.

NATASHA
I know.

ELXA
And he was right.

NATASHA
(beat)
I know that too.

Elxa throws up her hands and drops onto the couch.

ELXA
I hate him.

A connecting door to a small adjoining office opens. Robert comes through carrying a bag of takeout from a Jackson Avenue Jamaican spot. He sets it on the desk without a word, then looks at his son.

ROBERT
(deadpan, a perfect imitation)
"Common name, sir."

Elxa bursts out laughing. Even Natasha cracks.

MARC
What was I supposed to say?

ROBERT
"Is it," is what I was supposed to say. And I said it beautifully. (unpacking the containers) Oxtail, rice and peas, plantains. Your mother hasn't eaten since noon, and a granola bar is an apology to food, not food.

The four of them sit around the Chief's desk eating takeout out of foam containers at 1:52 in the morning, on top of budget reports. A family.

NATASHA
(pointing her fork)
Let's be very clear. In this building, I'm the Chief. Your sister is your resident. Your father is an attending who will not, under any circumstances, save you.

ROBERT
Under any circumstances.

NATASHA
Nobody here gives you anything you didn't earn. Nobody here knows who you are unless you tell them. That was your choice, and we'll honor it. But it cuts both ways, Marc-Anthony. No favors. No mercy.

MARC
So... a normal family.

ELXA
(mouth full)
The most normal.

Natasha's BlackBerry buzzes on the desk. She looks at it and holds it up.

NATASHA
Your grandfather. It's two in the morning, and he wants a full report.

MARC
How does he even...?

NATASHA
Graves was one of the very first Mercer Scholars. Nothing happens in American surgery that Victor Donohue doesn't hear about by dawn.

MARC
Tell Grandpa I held a brain.

ELXA
You held a SUCTION.

MARC
Near a brain! I was adjacent to a brain!

Natasha types. Robert eats. Outside the window, Manhattan glitters.

MARC (V.O.)
Everybody comes to this hospital carrying something.

MARC (V.O.)
A name. A secret. A fear. Something they're trying to outrun.

TAG

43 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - DAY
SATURDAY, JULY 2, 2005 - 12:24 PM

Bright noon. Hunters Point is humid and sleepy. Marc, post-call and dead on his feet, walks up 49th Avenue. On his stoop: Harmony, with three suitcases and a box of her mother's Tupperware, and Raven, with one duffel bag and a hot-comb kit. They're waiting.

MARC
...It's been eleven hours.

RAVEN
You said four hundred and groceries. We brought groceries.

Harmony holds up a bag. Raven holds up a loaf of bread and a pack of Kraft Singles.

RAVEN
Perfect grilled cheese.

Marc laughs, too tired to do anything else, and unlocks the door. Through the front window we can see his TV. LIVE 8 from Philadelphia is playing to an empty living room.

HARMONY
(walking in, stunned, looking up at the ceilings)
Oh my God. Oh my God. Marc. This is... what do your parents DO?

MARC
(closing the door behind them)
They really like me.

44 EXT. WORLD'S FAIR MARINA - FLUSHING BAY - THE SAILBOAT "CLARENCE" - DAY
SATURDAY, JULY 2, 2005 - 12:41 PM

Masts clink in the hot breeze. Planes roar low into LaGuardia across the water. A weathered 1978 sailboat, CLARENCE painted on its stern in fading letters.

Esther sits on deck in a tank top, her hair down for the first time all episode, knees pulled to her chest. She takes the thin chain from around her neck. On it hangs a WEDDING RING.

She looks at it for a long moment. Then she puts it back around her neck and tucks it under her shirt.

MARC (V.O.)
And this place, this old, broke, stubborn, beautiful hospital, doesn't ask you to put it down.

MARC (V.O.)
It just says: enter.

A plane thunders overhead. Esther doesn't look up.

MARC (V.O.)
You are welcome here.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 1x01

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

MySpace: bulletin from HarmonyDivine_QNS

Thursday, June 30, 2005, 10:15 PM. Mood: nervous. Now playing: Mariah Carey, "We Belong Together"

"tomorrow i become DR. Divine at Queens Grace!!! 5:30 am on a ROOF. pray for me and pray for my patients lol. mommy already cried twice. my top 8 is about to be all doctors, sorry Tasha." Comments (31): *"PROUD OF YOU BABY GIRL" (Lillian Divine; she has learned MySpace for this)*

AIM away message: AortaOrBust79 (Amond Baker)

Thursday, June 30, 2005, 11:48 PM

"Asleep. Tomorrow I become a surgeon. Do not IM me unless you are dying. If you are dying, call 911, then IM me with your symptoms."

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Marc-Anthony Bullock)

Friday, July 1, 2005, 4:52 AM and 4:57 AM

N.: "5:30. The roof. Do not be late. I mean it."

Marc: "Never been late a day in my life."

(Delivered 5:27 AM, the moment he came through the roof door.) ***N.:*** *"Technically."*

MySpace: bulletin from KeKe_SouthJamaica (Destiny's best friend)

Friday, July 1, 2005, 9:40 PM

"PRAY FOR DESTINY!!! she's at Queens Grace getting BRAIN SURGERY rn. no more details, her mom said don't put her business out there. but she'd want y'all to know she was gonna WIN tomorrow. Miss Teen Queens 2005 is hers in spirit. Repost this." Reposts: 64

BlackBerry email: from V. Donohue to N. Donohue

Saturday, July 2, 2005, 2:14 AM. Subject: Your son

"Leland called. He says the boy didn't move. Of course he didn't. Tell him I'm proud. Do NOT tell him I said so. And tell Robert the oxtail was a nice touch. Leland told me that too. V."

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Saturday, July 2, 2005, 2:03 AM

"Day 1 report: 18 Gracelings in, one cried at the Dawn Oath (not naming names, Divine), one asked the Warden if there was a dress code for 'smiling' (Cummings, girl...), and the tall one with the dimples was spotted leaving Monty's on Thursday night NOT alone. On the night BEFORE day one?? Bold. ALSO: a certain intern held suction through an aneurysm rupture tonight, and Graves told him, quote, 'You didn't move.' Graves has not complimented an intern since 1997. Welcome to Grace, babies." Comments (22).

QUEENS CHRONICLE: Queens Grace Welcomes 18 New Surgeons-in-Training

Thursday, July 7, 2005

LONG ISLAND CITY. Eighteen new surgical interns climbed to the roof of Queens Grace Hospital at 5:30 a.m. last Friday, July 1, for a tradition dating to 1968, reciting the hospital's founding words as the sun rose behind them over Queens.

"Some of you will not finish," Chief of Surgery Dr. Natasha Donohue told the class. "The ones who do will never be the same."

The hospital, which posted a $38 million operating deficit last year, continues to treat more uninsured patients than any hospital in western Queens.

Sidebar: Miss Teen Queens 2005 pageant postponed one week "for family reasons involving a contestant," organizers said.

Continuity Sheet: Episode 1x01

New Canon Established

- Marc met Esther at Monty's on Thursday, June 30, 2005. She left his house at about 4:42 AM on July 1. They agreed it "didn't happen." Both say it did.
- Elxa's five rules: (1) Don't suck up. (2) When I page you, you run. (3) Never lie to me. (4) Patients first, egos never. (5) If I'm operating, hold something or hold still. The unwritten rule under rule 2: page your resident before God.
- Nicknames given: 'Pantene' (Esther, from Arianna), 'Double-O' / 'Licensed to kill' (Harmony, from Arianna), 'Juneteenth' (Harmony, from Amond), 'the Warden' (Elxa, from the interns).
- Esther's modeling campaign: 'Silk Press. Strong Roots.' (national, about 2003).
- Amond and Marc's pact: whoever gets the case, the other one is in the gallery. 'You're my day one.'
- Harmony and Raven move into the House on 49th Avenue on Saturday, July 2, 2005, for '$400 and groceries.'
- Esther wears a wedding ring on a chain under her scrubs (her husband, Clayton Hartwell, is not yet revealed).
- The family dinner ritual: takeout in the Chief's office after hours. Robert brings oxtail.
- Dr. Leland Graves was one of the first Mercer Scholars, and he reports to Victor Donohue.
- Elxa is nauseated by fish (she's about 7 weeks pregnant; no one knows yet, including Elxa).

Knowledge Tracker: Marc's True Identity (as of July 2, 2005, 2:00 AM)

Knows	Doesn't know
Natasha, Robert, Elxa, Grace, Victor, Joan, the Donohue uncles, Grandma Jo, Bernie Watkins, Dr. Leland Graves (through Victor)	Amond, Esther, Arianna, Harmony, Raven, Gloria (suspicious), Monty, all other staff and patients

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Destiny Lockhart	3/3/1988 (17)	ACOM aneurysm, 7 mm, with sentinel bleed; probable ADPKD	Craniotomy and clipping (Graves; Marc scrubbed). Intraoperative rupture, controlled	Neuro intact; neuro ICU
Earl Wynn	11/2/1946 (58)	Type A aortic dissection	Ascending aortic graft (Robert Bullock; Amond retracting)	Stable post-op
Lamar Pittman	1/14/1971 (34)	Retrocecal appendicitis	Open appendectomy (Harmony began; Elxa completed)	Stable

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Ernestine Pope	8/9/1923 (81)	Symptomatic cholelithiasis	Lap cholecystectomy scheduled 7/2/2005, 6:00 AM (Dr. Boykin)	Consented, through Raven

New Characters (to add to MA-005 and MA-006)

- **Dr. Leland Graves**, b. April 18, 1953 (52). Chief of Neurosurgery, QGH; one of the first Mercer Scholars. Recurring.
- **Dr. Thaddeus Boykin**, a surgical resident who supervises Arianna (mentioned only).
- **Destiny Lockhart** (b. March 3, 1988) and **Rochelle Lockhart** (b. November 9, 1969, a Rikers corrections officer). Guest; Destiny is promised a front-row return next year.
- **Earl Wynn**, **Lamar Pittman** (knows Howard Divine from the Q4 bus), **Ernestine Pope** (widow of Herbert Pope, 1921-2003, a 1977 blackout surgery survivor). Guest.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- Friday, July 1, 2005: Justice O'Connor's retirement letter was delivered that morning (on TV at 10:34 AM). Sunrise in NYC is about 5:25 AM. Live 8 (Philadelphia) was on Saturday, July 2.
- The ACGME 30-hour limit is observed: the shift runs 5:30 AM Friday to about 11:30 AM Saturday. The 12:24 PM tag is post-call.
- The medicine is accurate: unequal arm pressures in dissection; the ADPKD and berry aneurysm link; why a wide-neck aneurysm gets clipped rather than coiled; an intraoperative rupture controlled with a permanent clip; a retrocecal appendix.